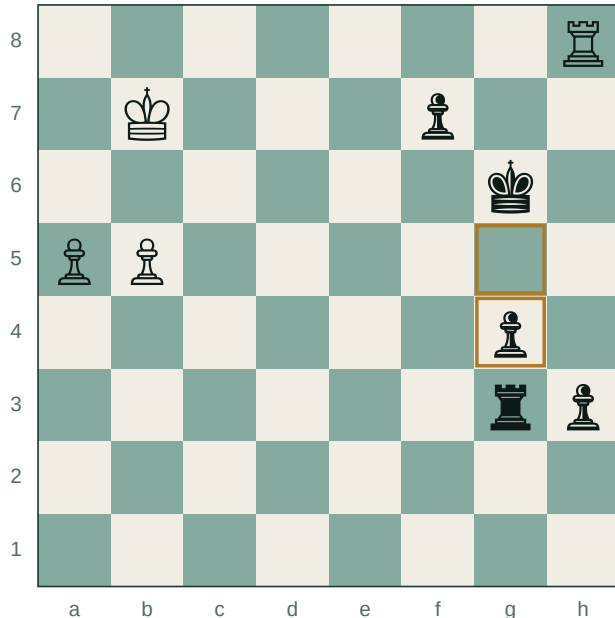


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 48

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 47...g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48. a6 h2 49. Rxh2

48.a6 The pawn moves from a5 to a6. Recorded reply: **48...h2**.

49.Rxh2 The rook captures the pawn on h2.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: rook on g3. Check for tactical protection.